



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Agriculture
BUREAU OF FISHERIES AND AQUATIC RESOURCES
REGIONAL FISHERIES LABORATORY XII
J. Catolico St., Lagao, General Santos City

Document Type Standard Operating Procedures	Revision No: 0	Date Adopted: 13 Aug 2019	Page No: Page 1 of 3
Document Code: SOP-02-02	GENERAL PROCEDURE FOR HOUSEKEEPING		

Introduction

This document gives the general procedure for housekeeping in the BFAR RFL XII, to ensure that the accommodation and environmental conditions will not invalidate the results or adversely affect the required quality of any measurement in the laboratory. The procedure covers good housekeeping that includes monitoring, control and record environmental conditions which influence the quality of the test results of the laboratory.

1. Responsibilities

1. Technical Manager
2. Laboratory Analysts
3. Laboratory Assistant Aide

2. Procedure

2.1. Good Housekeeping

2.1.1. Clean table tops before starting work, after each analysis, and at the end of the day.

The laboratory is free of clutter and cleaned regularly.

Work surfaces are cleaned up once there are spills of chemicals in the work area using the spill kit.

2.1.2. Clean floors before and after work.

Sweeping and wet mopping are preferred in cleaning the laboratory.

2.1.3. Dispose wastes appropriately in accordance with SOP 02-03, Handling, Collections and Disposal of Hazardous Wastes.

2.1.4. Do not use stairways and hallways as storage areas.

2.1.5. Never block exits, emergency equipments, and utility controls.

2.2 Hand washing

Laboratory analysts wash their hands after handling chemicals and culture media, after removing gloves and before leaving the laboratory area.

2.3 Laboratory Restriction

Access to the laboratory is restricted. The laboratory doors are closed and precaution (Unauthorized Person Not Allowed Inside) is posted in front of the doors of the laboratory areas.

2.4 Personal Protective Clothing

2.4.1 Laboratory Coats/Shoes

Wearing of laboratory gowns/shoes by the laboratory analysts are necessary when working with chemicals and culture media in the laboratory.

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Before leaving the laboratory area, laboratory gowns and shoes are removed and left in the laboratory.

2.4.2. Facial Protection

Facial masks and goggles/safety glasses are used by the laboratory analysts for facial protection where there is a potential of spattering chemicals that will affect the mucous membranes of the mouth, nose and eyes.

Preparation of reagents is done in laboratory fumehood to avoid possible spattering of chemicals. Preparation of culture media is done inside the microbiology working area.

2.4.3. Gloves

Gloves are used to protect the hands from contamination with chemicals and culture media.

Gloves are always checked for defects before use.

Gloves are changed frequently. Care is taken not to touch the skin with the outer surface of the gloves when removing. Hands are washed immediately after gloves are removed.

Gloves are removed prior to handling non-contaminated items such as door knobs, or telephones.

Gloves are not worn outside the laboratory area.

Gloves are not washed or disinfected for reuse. Detergents may cause enhanced penetration of liquids through undetected holes and disinfectants may cause deterioration.

2.4.4. Spillages

In case of chemical spillage:

Follow procedures recommended in the Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS) for particular chemicals.

In case of microbiological spillage:

Use protective gloves prior to clean up.

Cover affected area with tissue.

Pour sufficient amount of disinfectant over tissue.

Remove tissue and place into an autoclavable container.

Dry the area with tissue and place in autoclavable container.

Disinfect the area.

Decontaminate all contaminated materials in the sterilizer for 30 minutes at 121°C.

2.4.5. Airconditioners and Thermohygrometers

Thermohygrometers are installed in some areas of the laboratory to maintain temperature control.

Temperatures are monitored and recorded during working days.

2.4.6. Showers and Fire Extinguishers

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Showers are installed inside the laboratory for emergency use in cases where laboratory analysts are spattered/contaminated with chemicals.

Fire Extinguishers are also available inside the laboratory for emergency use in cases where there are hazards of fire.

2.4.7. Prohibited Activities

Smoking is not allowed inside the laboratory.

Food is not stored inside the laboratory refrigerators or prepared/consumed with laboratory glassware or utensils. Food is stored in refrigerator in the pantry and receiving area.

3. Documents

SOP 02-02, Handling, Collections and Disposal of Hazardous Wastes

4. Document History

Revision No.	Issue Date	Original Entry	Revised as	Recall Date

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